

Language Study

Reading Level 1
Penmanship & Copywork





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Reading Level 1, Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1

About Reading Level 1

The first years of reading instruction set a child on a path leading to a love of stories and books. The Alveary Level 1 Reading lessons integrate phonological awareness, phonics, and vocabulary within the traditional folk tales in the first Free and Treadwell Reader. Teacher read-alouds, shared reading, and independent reading are included throughout the course. Narration follows reading. Use of a Word Journal begins in the first term; children record new words and groups of similar words. They also add copywork, and later, short sentence dictations. Lessons include prediction, word work, and grammar topics such as sentence structure, nouns, verbs, punctuation, and capitalization. By the end of Level 1, children will decode and spell single sounds and syllables and read the stories with appropriate fluency.

About Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1

Copy letters and words and write them from dictation.



Placement & Combining Tips

Reading Level 1

Students who can already read may use the stories for reading practice but focus mainly on the spelling and grammar elements, including copywork and dictation.

Prerequisite: Students should recognize upper- and lower-case letters and know most of their sounds prior to starting this course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Reading Level 1 5 times/week 15 min	Reading Lessons: Level 1 (Revised 2025) Reading-Literature: The Primer
1	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 5 times/week 10 min	Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book B Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 1				
Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 Reading Level 1	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 Reading Level 1	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 Reading Level 1	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 Reading Level 1	Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 Reading Level 1



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the

time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Reading Level 1

☐ Carefully read "Literacy Development From Birth to Age 9" prior to beginning the day-to-day lessons.

☐ Print on cardstock, cut apart, sort, and label all Supplementary Materials for each lesson, found in the Introduction section of the Reading Lessons Teacher Guide. This should be completed before starting lessons with students. This is a crucial step needed in order to be successfully prepared for lessons.

☐ Supply a blank, lined Word Journal to students, which they will continue to add to and review in Levels 2 and 3.

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1

If you are using the Getty-Dubay Italic Handwriting Series, complete half a page per day or go at the student's pace.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Language Study: Grade 1

Reading Level 1



Reading Lessons: Level 1 (Revised 2025)



Reading-Literature: The Primer

Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1



Getty-Dubay® Italic Handwriting Book B



Italics: Beautiful Handwriting for Children



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Reading Level 1



Letter Tiles



Tile Organizer



Whisper Phone



Business Card Paper



Printable Big Tab Divider Inserts



Card Organizer



Plastic Organizer



Craft Sticks



Letter Tile Organizer



Quick Links

Language Study: Grade 1

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 8: English\)](#)

Reading Level 1

- ∞ [Alveary Reading Lesson Placement](#)
- ∞ [Literacy Development from Birth to Age 9](#)
- ∞ [Reading Level 1 Teacher Guide](#)
- ∞ [Scholastic webpage](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 14: Reading Lessons\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Language Study: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Each lesson after the first will begin with the dictation of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating the steps.

→ VISUALIZE

The student should visualize the letter and then write it from memory on his or her smaller chalkboard (the drag on the chalk helps them “feel” the stroke).

→ PRACTICE

The student will continue practicing the letter on the chalkboard until mastered from memory. Then, slowly and carefully copy the letter on the single practice line in the lesson.

→ EVALUATE

Allow the student to self-assess before writing another copy of the letter. The student continues copying from memory until able to produce six very good copies in a row.

Only focus on 1-2 letters per day at most, and allow as long as needed for particularly difficult letters or new stroke patterns. Use extra practice paper as needed, but celebrate when able to produce these six copies within the single practice line.

→ COPY

Once students have mastered enough letters, they may use time at the end of their writing lessons to copy words from their reading lesson word lists on their Penny Gardner lesson pages. Just flip back to the first word list and start from there. Students will need gentle reminding to visualize those words as a whole and to write them from memory rather than letter by letter.

★ TEACHER TIP

Even though the Penny Gardner Italics lessons include words, it's better to skip those initially. Stick to dictating 1-2 known letters as a warm-up, and then focus on learning 1-2 new letters per lesson until the lowercase letters are mastered.

★ TEACHER TIP

Use this space in your lesson plans to note what letters your student is ready to dictate for easy reference.

★ TEACHER TIP

If students have already mastered writing words during reading lessons, then you may have them move on to copying the nursery rhymes, poetry, and quotes found in the Penny Gardner Italics book during the COPY section of the lessons.

WEEK 1 15m Reading Level 1- Lesson 1

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ COMPLETE

The Little Red Hen
Lessons 1.1-1.4 this week

→ SUPPLEMENT

Use one day to finish incomplete lessons, read folktales and other books, or play games from the Appendix.

WEEK 2 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Dictate of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating the steps.

→ VISUALIZE

The student should visualize the letter and then write it from memory on his or her smaller chalkboard (the drag on the chalk helps them “feel” the stroke.)



Term 1

→ PRACTICE

The student will continue practicing the letter on the chalkboard until mastered from memory. Then, slowly and carefully copy the letter on the single practice line in the lesson.

→ EVALUATE

Allow the student to self-assess before writing another copy of the letter. The student continues copying from memory until able to produce six very good copies in a row.

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→ COPY

Once students have mastered enough letters, they may use time at the end of their writing lessons to copy words from their reading lesson word lists on their Penny Gardner lesson pages. Just flip back to the first word list and start from there. Students will need gentle reminding to visualize those words as a whole and to write them from memory rather than letter by letter.

WEEK 2 15m Reading Level 1 - Lesson 2

Tracker: 

→ COMPLETE

The Little Red Hen
Lessons 1.5-1.8 this week

→ SUPPLEMENT

Use one day to finish incomplete lessons, read folktales and other books, or play games from the Appendix.

WEEK 3 10m Penmanship & Copywork: Grade 1 - Tracker

Tracker: 

→ DICTATE/DEMONSTRATE

Dictate of 1-2 mastered letters. Simply call out a letter that has been mastered and have the child write it from memory on the Penny Gardner lined paper. Then the teacher should model any new strokes or letters properly on a chalkboard while narrating the steps.

→ VISUALIZE

The student should visualize the letter and then write it from memory on his or her smaller chalkboard (the drag on the chalk helps them “feel” the stroke).

→ PRACTICE

The student will continue practicing the letter on the chalkboard until mastered from memory. Then, slowly and carefully copy the letter on the single practice line in the lesson.

→ EVALUATE

Allow the student to self-assess before writing another copy of the letter. The student continues copying from memory until able to produce six very good copies in a row.

Only focus on 1-2 letters per day at most, and allow as long as needed for particularly difficult letters or new stroke patterns. Use extra practice paper as needed, but celebrate when able to produce these six

Term 1

copies within the single practice line.

→ COPY

Once students have mastered enough letters, they may use time at the end of their writing lessons to copy words from their reading lesson word lists on their Penny Gardner lesson pages. Just flip back to the first word list and start from there. Students will need gentle reminding to visualize those words as a whole and to write them from memory rather than letter by letter.

WEEK 3 15m Reading Level 1 - Lesson 3

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

→ COMPLETE

The Little Red Hen
Lessons 1.9-1.12 this week

→ SUPPLEMENT

Use one day to finish incomplete lessons, read folktales and other books, or play games from the Appendix.

SAMPLE